

Ubuntu – a journey worth knowing

Ubuntu, an open-source software, has been in the limelight ever since its launch 15 years ago. Built on Debian's infrastructure, it comprises of a Linux server along with desktop Operating Systems options. The Operating Systems company is funded by Canonical Ltd, which helps the Operating System developer sustain its growth in the Operating Systems market.

Ubuntu has been known to release new versions almost every six months; with each version receiving adequate support from the parent company for a period of approximately 9 months. The support includes the likes of, but is not limited to security fixes, high risk and low risk bug fixes.

On the contrary, the Long-Term Support (LTS) versions are supported for five years and are usually released every two years. LTS versions get regular updates and point releases, which include support for new hardware and a combination of all updates which might have been published in the version till date.

Ubuntu releases

Each release within the Ubuntu universe is recorded and identified by a unique version number. The version number consists of the year along with the month number in which the version is being released. As an example, let's look at the very first release of Ubuntu. Ubuntu 4.10 was released on 20 October 2004. Hence, the version number became 4.10. However, the future version numbers have become provisional now; if there is a delay in the launch of a specific version, the categorization numbers also change as per the release date.

Like Google, even Ubuntu believes in categorizing and naming each version, to give it a unique personality, so that the users can follow and relate to the latest versions. However, Ubuntu uses animal names, while Google uses dessert names for each of its versions. The latest release is the Ubuntu 19.04, which is the upgraded version of 18.10. The 18.10 is most commonly known as Cosmic Cuttlefish.

Ubuntu 19.04 – the new variant is a step up on 18.10.

Even though 18.10 was performing adequately well, Linux has released the newest version 19.04 Disco Dingo. Known to be the 30th release in the Operating Systems cycle, it has been tagged as a fun release which boasts up to date components. In other words, it's a heavenly update for users who want to lay their hands on the latest Linux/GNU software.